

# NOCLIP — Arcade Game 10 Design Document (the Slop shelf)

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## Overview

NOCLIP is a 1–6 player first-person co-op horror scavenging game on the Deep Arcade's new **Slop** shelf: the games that are knowingly a little cursed, a little internet, and very fun with friends. The crew are salvagers hired by a shady firm to go into the Backrooms (the endless liminal spaces behind reality), find things worth money, and get them out. There's no ship. Instead, scattered through the levels are **Threshold Labs**: abandoned industrial research stations, each with a portal back to the real world. Labs are where you drop loot, buy gear, rest, and signal the portal to charge so the crew can extract.

### What it takes from Lethal Company

- Co-op scavenging under a **quota**: bring back enough value in a set number of days or you're fired (and in this case, left behind).
- Scrap with weight and value that has to be carried by hand, so greed is a choice.
- Proximity voice: you hear teammates only when they're near, and the things in the dark hear you.
- Death that is funny for everyone else, and a ghost to watch from.
- A shop between runs; cheap gear that matters; a crew that gets better at the same awful places.

### What it takes from the Backrooms

- The first ten levels (0–9) of the Backrooms wiki's numbered list: the yellow Lobby, the warehouse Habitable Zone, Pipe Dreams, the Electrical Station, the Abandoned Office, the Terror Hotel, Lights Out, Thalassophobia, the Cave System, and the Darkened Suburbs, each with its mood, its hazards, and its entities.
- **Noclipping**: moving between levels by falling through reality at the wrong spot, plus the doors, stairwells, and strange exits each level has.
- Almond water, the hum, the smell of wet carpet, and entities that are a meme until one is behind you.

### What NOCLIP adds

1. **An expansive map.** Levels connect to each other and to the Labs; a run is a route through several levels, not one building.
2. **Threshold Labs** as outposts with portals, shops, storage, and generators to restart.
3. **The Surface:** the real world, where loot is sold to a fence for money and to the firm for the quota, and where the crew buys the next run.
4. **Sanity** as a second health bar: the Backrooms change what you see and hear the longer you're in them.
5. **Contracts:** each run has a job (retrieve a thing, rescue a lost crew, map a level, photograph an entity) on top of the quota.

## Design pillars

1. **Liminal first, monsters second.** The levels are scary because they're empty, endless, and almost normal. Entities are rare enough that each one is an event.
2. **Greed versus getting out.** Every extra minute is more loot and more risk; every Lab is a choice to cash in or go deeper.
3. **Navigation is the skill.** Knowing how levels connect, where the exits hide, and how to get back is what a veteran crew has that a new one doesn't.
4. **Funny with friends.** Proximity voice, ragdolls, a teammate's voice coming from the wrong direction, a shopping list that includes a traffic cone.

**Session.** A run is one "week" of three in-game days, about 45–60 minutes; a full campaign is runs until the quota beats the crew.

**A note on sources.** The ten levels and the entities named here are from the Backrooms community's shared mythology (the Backrooms wiki's level list). The game uses each level's premise and mood and invents its own layouts, mechanics, and loot; it doesn't reproduce wiki text.

## The run

### A campaign

The crew works for the **Liminal Recovery Bureau** (the Bureau), a firm that sells Backrooms objects to collectors and labs. The Bureau sets a **quota** every week. A week is three in-game days. Meet the quota by the end of day 3 and the crew is paid and the next quota is higher; miss it and the Bureau "stops maintaining the portals" for you, which ends the campaign with the crew left in the Backrooms (a game-over screen in the Bureau's dry memo style).

## A day

1. **Briefing (the Surface).** The crew is in the Bureau's warehouse in the real world. They see the quota, the days left, today's **contract** (an optional job with a bonus), and the **forecast** (which levels are "active" today: more loot, more entities). They buy gear with money from previous sales.
2. **Insertion.** The Bureau's portal drops the crew into a Threshold Lab chosen by the crew from those they've unlocked. Every crew starts its first day at **Lab Alpha**, on Level 0.
3. **The shift.** About 12–18 real minutes of in-game time (a day is 06:00 to 24:00 Backrooms time; the clock is on every watch). The crew explores, scavenges, carries loot back to a Lab, moves between levels, and comes back. The Backrooms get worse as the day goes on: more entities after 18:00; the lights flicker more; after midnight anyone still out is in the **Overtime** (below).
4. **Extraction.** At any Lab the crew can **signal the portal**: a 30 s charge-up the crew has to defend (the portal's hum is the loudest thing in the level and draws entities). When it opens, everyone in the Lab is pulled to the Surface with everything stored in the Lab's drop-off.
5. **The Surface (end of day).** Loot is sold: to the Bureau for quota credit, or to the **Fence** for cash (see The Surface). The crew restocks. The next day starts from the Lab they extracted from, or any other unlocked Lab.

## Overtime

If the clock passes 24:00 with crew still in the Backrooms, the portal network shuts until 06:00. Anyone outside a Lab is stuck for the night: the lights go out level-wide, entity activity triples, and the only safe places are Labs with their generators running. Surviving the night in a Lab with loot is a legitimate (insane) strategy: the morning's extraction counts for the next day. Surviving it outside a Lab is a story.

## How a run ends

- **The quota is met at week's end:** the crew is paid, a bonus is offered to the player who brought in the most (a cosmetic token bonus), and a new week begins with a higher quota and a new forecast.
- **The quota is missed:** campaign over; a score screen shows weeks survived, total loot, entities documented, levels reached, and how everyone died.

- **Everyone dies in a day:** the loot in Labs is kept, the loot carried is lost, and the crew respawns at the Surface the next morning minus a death fee (a percentage of cash). A crew can afford a few of these.

## Pacing of a session

A session is 2–4 days (45–90 minutes). Nothing is gated: all twenty levels are reachable from day one through their exits, and a crew can go as deep as it dares whenever it wants. The quota is what pushes. A typical crew makes the first quota working Levels 0–3, the second by reaching 5–7, and may hold at 7–8 for the third; after that the quotas can only be met with deep loot, so Levels 10–19 become the job. Level 11 is the deep hub, and Lab Omega at Level 19's Abyss Inn is the campaign's long goal. Quotas grow 40% a week to week four and 35% after, and the only way to keep up is to go deeper.

## The survivor

Every player is a Bureau salvager in a hard hat and a hi-vis vest with a headlamp, a backpack, and three meters: health, sanity, and stamina. There is no hunger or thirst; the Backrooms wear you down through your mind, not your stomach. The meters are simple; together they're the run's clock.

| Meter          | Range | Drains from                                                                                                                                        | Restored by                                                                                                       | At zero            |
|----------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Health</b>  | 100   | Entities, falls, hazards, electricity, drowning                                                                                                    | Medkits, bandages, resting in a Lab (slowly)                                                                      | Downed (see Death) |
| <b>Sanity</b>  | 100   | Time in the Backrooms (–1 per minute), darkness, being alone (no teammate within 15 m: –1 per 20 s), seeing an entity, the hum, a teammate's death | Almond water (+25), a teammate's voice nearby (+1 per 30 s), Lab lights (+5 per minute), music boxes, the Surface | Lost (see below)   |
| <b>Stamina</b> | 100   | Sprinting, climbing, carrying heavy loot                                                                                                           | Walking, standing still                                                                                           | Can't sprint       |

## Sanity, in detail

Sanity is the Backrooms getting into your head. It is the game's most important meter because it changes what's real for that player.

| Sanity | What the player experiences                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 100–70 | Normal                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 69–50  | The hum gets louder; walls breathe slightly at the edge of vision; a fluorescent light flickers that the others can't see                                                                                                       |
| 49–30  | False sounds: footsteps behind, a teammate's voice from the wrong direction (synthesized from that teammate's recent voice lines), a door that wasn't there; Smilers' eyes in dark corners that aren't real (and sometimes are) |
| 29–10  | Fake entities: hallucinated Hounds and Facelings that move toward you and vanish on contact; loot shows the wrong value; the minimap lies by a room                                                                             |
| 9–1    | Your teammates sometimes look like Facelings; your own voice on proximity is distorted for others                                                                                                                               |
| 0      | <b>Lost:</b> the player wanders off on autopilot toward the nearest noclip point for 10 s unless a teammate grabs them; if they reach it, they noclip to a random level alone                                                   |

Hallucinations are per-player and client-side: the others don't see them, so a crew learns to ask "do you see that?" over voice, which is the point.

## Carrying

- A backpack holds 4 small items (tools, consumables) and 2 small loot items. Loot comes in sizes: small (in a pocket slot), medium (in the hands, one at a time, –15% speed), large (two hands, –30% speed, no tools usable), and huge (two players carry it together, –40%).
- Weight slows sprinting and drains stamina. Dropping loot is instant (a key) and makes a noise; throwing it is a 3 m toss that makes more.
- A **cart** (shop item) carries 6 medium items or 2 large; it's loud on hard floors and silent on carpet.

## Injuries

Hits do health damage and sometimes an injury: a **sprain** (no sprint until a bandage), a **bleed** (−1 health per 3 s until a bandage; leaves a trail that Hounds follow), a **break** (half speed until a splint), **electrocution** (a 2 s stun, drops what you're holding).

## Death

- At 0 health a player is **downed**: they crawl, they can talk (proximity), and they bleed out over 40 s unless a teammate revives them (6 s with a medkit; 15 s without, and the reviver can't do anything else).
- A dead player drops everything they carried and becomes a **Wanderer**: a ghost who can drift through walls at walking speed, see entities through walls, and talk to the living only in a whisper they can barely hear within 3 m. Wanderers can't touch anything but can stand somewhere and be an arrow. They respawn at the Surface next morning.
- Some entities don't kill; they take. A player taken by a Skin-Stealer is replaced by one (see Entities). A player swallowed by Level 7's water reappears on Level 8 a minute later with no gear and 10 sanity. A player who noclips while Lost is alive and alone somewhere.

## Threshold Labs

The Labs are the crew's ship, split into outposts across the map. Each is an abandoned research station from whoever studied the Backrooms before the Bureau: concrete, steel doors, banks of CRT monitors, chalkboards of equations, a generator, and in the center a ring of machinery around a portal that opens to the Surface. Every level has one or two; most start **dormant** and have to be found and restarted.

### The rooms of a Lab

| Room                   | What it does                                                            |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Portal Hall</b> | The ring and the control desk. The portal is signalled here (see below) |

| Room                        | What it does                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Drop-off</b>         | A row of lockers and a conveyor that takes loot into the Bureau's sealed crate. Anything in the crate goes to the Surface on extraction and counts toward the day's sale. Loot in the crate is safe from everything except a Lab breach         |
| <b>The Commissary</b>       | A vending terminal: the shop (see Equipment). Prices are Lab-specific (a Lab deep in Level 6 charges more for batteries and less for almond water)                                                                                              |
| <b>The Bunks</b>            | Sleep for 30 s to restore 20 sanity once per day; the only rest in the Backrooms                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>The Generator Room</b>   | Powers the Lab's lights, doors, and portal. Generators need fuel (a canister found on most levels) to run past the day; a Lab with a dead generator is dark, its doors don't lock, and its portal can't be signalled                            |
| <b>The Observation Room</b> | CRT monitors on cameras the Lab placed in its level: the crew can watch hallways, see entities on their routes, and talk over an intercom to anyone near a camera. A player at the monitors is the crew's guide, Lethal Company's terminal role |
| <b>The Archive</b>          | Filing cabinets of the old researchers' notes: lore, and at each Lab one <b>map fragment</b> of how its level connects to others                                                                                                                |

## Restarting a dormant Lab

1. Find it (the Bureau's map shows roughly where; the level's exits and the old researchers' arrows point to it).
2. Get inside: the blast door needs power from a **breaker** found somewhere in the level, or a crowbar and two players (loud).
3. Fuel the generator (one canister) and flip the breakers.
4. The Lab is now **online** for the rest of the campaign: insertion point, drop-off, shop, rest, cameras, and an extraction point.

Each restarted Lab is a permanent foothold, which is how a crew pushes deeper week by week.

## Signalling the portal

1. At the control desk, a player starts the **signal**: a 30 s charge with a rising hum and the ring spinning up.
2. During the charge the Lab's lights pulse, the hum carries across the level, and entities that hear it come. Doors can be locked from the desk (if the generator is running); a breach (an entity through a door, or a Smiler in the dark corners if the lights flicker) is the crew's fight.
3. The charge can be paused (the hum stops, progress holds) and resumed, which is how a crew hides from a Hound pack mid-charge.
4. At 100%, the portal opens for 20 s. Everyone in the Portal Hall goes to the Surface; the crate goes with them. Anyone outside is left behind (and can extract from another Lab or wait for tomorrow).
5. A Lab's portal needs a cooldown (one in-game hour) after an extraction.

## Lab breaches

If an entity gets into the Drop-off while nobody's there, it can **tip the crate**: a third of the stored loot is scattered in the Lab and has to be re-dropped, and the most valuable item may be carried off (it's in the level now, somewhere). Locking the Drop-off's door keeps it safe as long as the generator runs.

## Lab upgrades (bought on the Surface, installed per Lab)

Floodlights (no Smilers inside the Lab), reinforced doors (twice as long to breach), a second camera bank, a quick-charge coil (20 s charge, but the hum is twice as loud), a fuel tank (generator runs two days), a cargo link (the Lab's crate can send loot to another online Lab's crate without extracting, once per hour), and the **Siren**: a speaker that, when played, draws every entity in the level to the Lab, which is a terrible idea except for one contract.

## The Lab network

Every online Lab is part of one synced network by default. Restarting a Lab adds it to the network for the whole crew for the rest of the campaign.

- **Jumping.** At any online Lab's portal, a player can jump to any other online Lab: a 10 s charge (quieter than an extraction, about a third of the hum), then they step out of the destination Lab's ring. One jump per player per in-game hour. A player can jump carrying what they hold; the crate doesn't travel.
- **Rejoining the crew.** The network's main use is the one the crew will use constantly: a player who has pushed ahead and restarted a deep Lab can jump back to the Lab where teammates are, and a teammate can jump forward to them. Splitting up and regrouping is cheap, so a crew can scout in pairs and meet at a Lab.
- **Shared state.** Every online Lab shows the same crate total (each Lab's crate is still its own physical store, but the Portal Hall's board shows all of them), the same map (everything any teammate has seen syncs at any Lab), the same Observation feeds (any Lab's monitors can switch to any other Lab's cameras), and the same intercom (a player at one Lab can talk to a player at another).
- **Extracting from anywhere.** An extraction at any Lab sends every crate in the network to the Surface, not just its own, as long as the other Labs' generators are running. A crew can drop loot all over the map and cash it out from the Lab nearest its last stand.
- **Calling the crew.** A player at a Lab can **summon**: everyone else gets a prompt to jump there (each still on their own hourly jump), which is how a scattered crew regroupes for a deep Lab's extraction.
- **When the network fails.** A Lab whose generator dies drops off the network (its crate is stuck until it's refuelled; its jumps are offline). In Overtime the network goes down entirely until 06:00. Level 12's Lab is the exception noted in that level.

## The ten levels

Each level is procedurally generated from its own rules every day (a seed per day per level), with fixed landmarks (its Labs, its exits, a handful of set pieces) so a crew can learn it without memorizing it. Difficulty rises with the number. Every level has a **mood rule** that makes it play unlike the others.

### Level 0: The Lobby

- **Look:** Endless rooms of mono-yellow wallpaper, damp beige carpet, buzzing fluorescent panels; no windows, no furniture, no end.
- **Generation:** A maze of rooms and corridors on a grid, with random wall removals so it's never quite a maze; pillars; occasional rooms of a different size.

- **Mood rule — The Hum:** the lights' buzz drains sanity slowly (−1 per 90 s extra); silence (a room with a dead light) restores it, and dead lights are where Smilers are. Direction is meaningless: the compass spins.
- **Hazards:** Getting lost; dead-light rooms; **carpet stains** that are damp and squelch (noise); the occasional **manila room** (a different wallpaper: noclip spot).
- **Entities:** Rare. A **Faceling** or two wandering; a **Smiler** in dark rooms after 18:00.
- **Loot:** Low value, light, everywhere: abandoned backpacks, VHS tapes, a working flashlight, an office chair, almond water, someone's wallet.
- **Labs:** Lab Alpha (the start).
- **Exits:** Noclip through a manila-room wall (to Level 1); a **stairwell door** that's sometimes there (to Level 2); fall through the floor in a carpet-stain room (to Level 1, painfully).

## Level 1: The Habitable Zone

- **Look:** A vast concrete warehouse: grey floors and walls, exposed rebar, puddles, steel crates on racks, fluorescent lights that occasionally flicker off for minutes. Fog in low rooms.
- **Generation:** Large halls connected by corridors and ramps; supply crates in clusters; stairwells.
- **Mood rule — Supply Crates:** crates spawn and despawn when nobody's looking: a room checked is a room that might have changed. Crates hold the level's loot and supplies (almond water, batteries, food), so Level 1 is where a crew restocks.
- **Hazards:** Lights-out periods (2–5 minutes; entities move); fog rooms (sight 5 m).
- **Entities:** **Hounds** (in packs of 2–3 during lights-out), **Dullers** (slow, grey, everywhere when the lights are off), **Facelings** (wanderers; some trade).
- **Loot:** Medium value: crates of tools, a generator part, a crate of almond water (sells well), old Bureau equipment, a Faceling's mask (very valuable, see Entities).
- **Labs:** Lab Beta (dormant), near a large hall with a loading door.
- **Exits:** Stairwells down (Level 2); a loading-bay door that opens onto Level 3 (rare); noclip through a flickering wall (Level 0 or 4).

## Level 2: Pipe Dreams

- **Look:** Long, narrow maintenance tunnels of grey concrete with pipes on every wall and ceiling; some pipes leak hot water or steam; dim red bulbs; sweltering.

- **Generation:** Long corridors with side rooms, branching at junctions; dead ends are frequent; valves.
- **Mood rule — Heat:** the heat drains stamina 2× (sprints are short and recovery is slow) and sanity 1.5×; steam pipes burst when shot, hit, or randomly (scald 20, fog 5 s); valves open and close sections (a puzzle and a trap).
- **Hazards:** Steam bursts; electrified puddles near junction boxes; dead-end tunnels whose hatches seal behind you until someone opens the right valve.
- **Entities:** **Wretches** (once-people, now feral, in packs in side rooms), **Clumps** (masses of limbs that crawl along pipes), **Hounds**.
- **Loot:** Medium: brass valves, pressure gauges, a lost crew's toolbox, cans of food, a copper pipe section (heavy, valuable).
- **Labs:** Lab Gamma (dormant), behind a valve-sealed door.
- **Exits:** A ladder up through a manhole (Level 3); a pipe that's big enough to crawl (Level 4); a steam vent noclip (Level 1).

### Level 3: The Electrical Station

- **Look:** Brick and concrete halls full of humming machinery, transformers, conveyor belts, cages of wiring; the air smells of ozone; very hot; loud.
- **Generation:** A grid of machine halls with catwalks above and crawlspaces below; breakers; locked cages.
- **Mood rule — Power:** the whole level runs on breakers. Throwing breakers changes which doors open, which machines run (noise covers footsteps), and which floors are electrified. A crew with a map of breakers controls the level.
- **Hazards:** Live floors (the conveyor halls), arc flashes, crushing machinery, heat (stamina drains 2× and the shimmer blurs vision past 20 m), noise that hides entities' tells.
- **Entities:** **Hounds**, **Smilers** in powered-down halls, **Skin-Stealers** (begin appearing here; see Entities), **Deathmoths** (eggs in warm corners).
- **Loot:** High: fuses, breakers, a working radio, copper coils (heavy), machine parts, a transformer core (huge, two players, very valuable).
- **Labs:** Lab Delta (dormant), in a control room above the main hall.
- **Exits:** An elevator that works when powered (Level 4); a ladder down to Level 2; a freight door to Level 1; a transformer room noclip (Level 6, unpowered = very dark).

## Level 4: The Abandoned Office

- **Look:** An endless empty office floor: carpet, drop ceilings, cubicles, windows that show only darkness; water coolers that work; quiet.
- **Generation:** Office blocks of cubicles, meeting rooms, break rooms, stairwells, elevator banks; repeats with small changes.
- **Mood rule — Safe Haven:** Level 4 is the calmest level: entities are rare and slow; water coolers are almond water. It's the crew's rest stop and a trap for the greedy (loot is poor, and staying too long is a sanity drain from the windows).
- **Hazards:** The windows: looking out for more than 3 s drains 10 sanity; an elevator that sometimes goes somewhere else.
- **Entities:** Rare **Facelings** (often friendly; traders), **Dullers**, the occasional **Partygoer** balloon (see Entities) drifting through.
- **Loot:** Low to medium: office supplies, a computer tower, files (the Bureau buys documents), a coffee machine, a desk plant, someone's photo.
- **Labs:** Lab Epsilon (dormant), in a server room.
- **Exits:** Stairwells (Level 5 up, Level 3 down), the elevator (random: Level 5, 6, or 2), a cubicle with no walls (noclip to Level 0); a door at the end of a corridor that opens onto a school hallway (Level 18).

## Level 5: The Terror Hotel

- **Look:** A grand 1920s hotel: red carpet, gold sconces, endless corridors of numbered doors, a ballroom, a boiler room in the basement; jazz from somewhere.
- **Generation:** Floors of corridors with rooms behind doors; a lobby, a ballroom, a kitchen, and the boiler room as set pieces; stairs and an elevator.
- **Mood rule — The Rooms:** most doors are locked; key cards (loot) open them. Rooms have the level's best loot and its worst surprises. Room numbers are a pattern a crew can learn (rooms ending in 3 are traps). The jazz gets louder near danger.
- **Hazards:** Trapped rooms, the boiler (scalding, and it explodes if left running), mirrors that show someone behind you.
- **Entities:** **The Partygoers** (smiling figures in party hats from the ballroom who want you to join the party), **Skin-Stealers**, **Hounds** in the kitchen.
- **Loot:** High: jewelry, silver trays, a gramophone, champagne, the hotel's ledger (valuable), a room key to the Penthouse (contract item).
- **Labs:** Lab Zeta (dormant), behind the boiler room.

- **Exits:** The boiler room's furnace (Level 6, cold and dark on the other side), the elevator (Level 4 or 7), a window that opens onto water (Level 7).

## Level 6: Lights Out

- **Look:** Total darkness. Concrete corridors that can only be seen by what you bring. The air is still; there's no hum.
- **Generation:** A long, winding, mostly linear set of corridors with occasional rooms; few landmarks.
- **Mood rule — The Dark:** no light sources work for long (batteries drain 5×); sounds are louder; sanity drains 3×. Teammates' voices are the only comfort, and the voices are sometimes not teammates. A glow stick lasts 30 s.
- **Hazards:** Everything, unseen; pits; the voices.
- **Entities:** **Smilers** everywhere (eyes and teeth in the dark), **Hounds** by sound, **Skin-Stealers** imitating voices.
- **Loot:** Few items, all valuable: a glowing lantern (worth a lot and works here), an old researcher's camera with film, a box of batteries.
- **Labs:** Lab Eta (dormant), a Lab that has never been lit; restarting it is the hardest task in week three.
- **Exits:** A door at the end that opens onto water (Level 7); a pit (Level 8); walk long enough and you're in Level 0 (the only way back without a Lab).

## Level 7: Thalassophobia

- **Look:** A small room or two of an old house, and beyond them, an endless dark ocean. The house's lower floors are flooded.
- **Generation:** A few rooms above the water, a flooded basement below, and the ocean (a fixed-size open water area with a floor far below).
- **Mood rule — The Water:** most of the level is underwater; swimming drains stamina; diving needs a breathing tank (shop); something very large lives in it and anything in the water for more than 60 s draws it. Loot is in the flooded house and on the sea floor.
- **Hazards:** Drowning; the cold (stamina drain); the thing in the water.
- **Entities:** The **Leviathan of Level 7** (one enormous presence that pulls swimmers down; a player taken reappears in Level 8, see Death), **Deathmoths** around the house's lamps.
- **Loot:** High and heavy: a ship's bell, waterlogged chests, a diving helmet, the house's family silver.

- **Labs:** None (the only level without one): a crew comes here and leaves.
- **Exits:** The basement's drain (Level 8); swim down into the dark (Level 8, if the Leviathan doesn't intervene); the front door (Level 6); swim far enough out and a grey hull appears (Level 17).

## Level 8: The Cave System

- **Look:** Rock caves, tunnels, chasms, underground rivers, crystal formations, spider webs. Cold. Dripping.
- **Generation:** A 3D cave network with vertical shafts, chasms with bridges, and large chambers.
- **Mood rule — Verticality:** climbing (ropes, ladders found and placed) and falling are the level; the crew needs ropes and lights; the deeper the cave, the better the loot and the bigger the spiders.
- **Hazards:** Falls; cave-ins (noise triggers them); rivers that sweep you; webs that hold you.
- **Entities:** **Spiders** (the Backrooms' cave arachnids, large and many-eyed), **Crawlers**, **Hounds**, **Deathmoths** in the warm chambers.
- **Loot:** High: crystals (the most valuable small loot in the game), old mining equipment, gold ore, a lost researcher's journal.
- **Labs:** Lab Theta (dormant), in a chamber reached by a long rope descent.
- **Exits:** A tunnel that opens into a suburban street (Level 9); an underground river noclip (Level 7); climb all the way up (Level 1); a ladder up into a farm cellar (Level 10).

## Level 9: The Darkened Suburbs

- **Look:** An endless American suburb at night: identical houses, streetlights (some working), lawns, a sky with no stars. Houses are dark inside.
- **Generation:** A street grid of houses with yards and fences; house interiors from a kit; a park, a school, a convenience store as set pieces.
- **Mood rule — The Houses:** houses are the loot and the danger; each is a small dungeon; their front doors lock behind you sometimes. Streetlights are safe; the dark between them isn't. The level is too big to search, so contracts send crews to specific addresses.
- **Hazards:** The dark between streetlights; houses that change when you leave a room; the ice cream truck's song.

- **Entities:** **Skin-Stealers** in houses (wearing the residents), **The Neighbors** (a Level 9-specific entity: figures standing in windows that are closer every time you look away), **Hounds** in the dark streets, **Smilers** inside dark houses.
- **Loot:** Very high: TVs, jewelry, family photos (strange), toys, a car battery, the convenience store's register.
- **Labs:** Lab Iota (dormant), in the school's basement: the deepest Lab, and the hardest extraction (the school is full).
- **Exits:** A storm drain (Level 8); the convenience store's back door (Level 4, rarely); a house with all its lights on (Level 0); a crop circle in a back yard (Level 10) and a white house's front door (Level 12, sometimes).

## The deep levels (10-19)

The next ten levels in the Backrooms wiki's numbered list, part of the same map and reachable at any time; the rising quota is what drives a crew down into them. They are bigger, stranger, and worth far more; each has a Lab that is harder to restart, and two of them break the rules the crew has learned. Names follow the wiki's list; where the wiki's take on a level is thin or varied, the game builds from the name and premise.

### Level 10: The Bumper Crop

- **Look:** An endless wheat field under an overcast sky; a wind that never stops; a barn, a silo, a scarecrow on a pole every few hundred meters; a dirt road.
- **Generation:** Open terrain with wheat at shoulder height (sight 3 m inside it, 200 m above it), roads, farm buildings as landmarks.
- **Mood rule — The Wheat:** inside the wheat nobody can see anything, including entities; the wheat moves in the wind and also when something walks through it, so the only tell is a wave that goes against the wind. Climbing a silo or a barn roof gives the view; standing there makes you the only thing visible for a mile.
- **Hazards:** Getting lost (the compass works here, the only deep level where it does); a combine harvester that drives the road and the field on a route; storms that flatten the wheat for a minute.
- **Entities:** **The Scarecrows** (they're on different poles each time you look; one per field comes down at dusk), **Hounds** in the wheat.
- **Loot:** Medium-high, heavy: farm tools, a tractor battery, sacks of grain (the Bureau pays for Backrooms grain), a barn's tack, the farmhouse's quilt.

- **Labs:** Lab Kappa, under the silo.
- **Exits:** The road's end (Level 11); the barn's cellar (Level 8); a crop circle (noclip to Level 9).

## Level 11: The Concrete Jungle

- **Look:** An endless empty city: skyscrapers, streets, traffic lights cycling for no one, shopfronts, an overcast day that doesn't end.
- **Generation:** A city grid with blocks of buildings; most doors are locked; some buildings are open from ground to roof; a subway.
- **Mood rule — The Safe City:** Level 11 is the deep levels' haven. Entities are rare in the open; the city's shops have supplies (almond water from vending machines, batteries from a hardware store). It's where a crew restocks deep. The danger is height: loot is in the towers, and the towers are tall.
- **Hazards:** Falls; elevators that work and stop between floors; the subway (trains run).
- **Entities:** Rare **Facelings** (the traders are here in numbers: a Faceling market in a plaza), **Deathmoths** on rooftops.
- **Loot:** Medium-high: shop stock, an office's server, a penthouse's art (huge), a jeweler's case, a car battery from a parked car.
- **Labs:** Lab Lambda, in a tower's basement; the safest Lab in the game, and a natural hub.
- **Exits:** The subway (Level 13 or Level 15); a storm drain (Level 10); a tower's top floor (Level 17); a door that opens into a white house (Level 12).

## Level 12: Aedificium (In the Flesh)

- **Look:** It starts as an ordinary suburban house: a garage, a hall, rooms with furniture. The longer you're there, the more the walls are skin, the floors are warm, the doors are something else, and there are eyes.
- **Generation:** A house that rebuilds itself: rooms generate as you enter them and change when nobody looks; the layout loops.
- **Mood rule — The Living House:** the level is one entity. It doesn't chase; it *digests*. Every minute in Level 12 drains sanity 2× and adds static to every player's screen; radios and the Lab network don't work (signals can't leave or enter), so a crew in Level 12 is cut off. Televisions show static and, at low sanity, the other players.
- **Hazards:** Rooms that close (a doorway seals and the crew must find another way); floors that soften; time loss (a player who stares at a TV loses a minute).

- **Entities: Seers** (eyes in the walls, ceilings, and furniture that watch; being watched by three at once draws the house's attention: a room seals on you), the house itself.
- **Loot:** Very high, and strange: furniture from nowhere, a family's photo albums of people who were never there, a TV that shows a real channel, a heart-shaped thing in a jar (huge value, cursed).
- **Labs:** Lab Mu, in the garage, **off the network** (it works as a Lab, but its portal can only extract, not jump, and its crate doesn't sync until the crew extracts from it).
- **Exits:** The garage door (Level 11); the attic (Level 19); the front door, sometimes (Level 9).

### Level 13: Vitrum Madness

- **Look:** A maze of glass: walls, floors, and ceilings of clear and frosted glass and mirrors; everything is visible and nothing is reachable; light bends.
- **Generation:** A 3D lattice of glass corridors with mirror panels; some glass is clear (see through, can't pass), some frosted, some mirror.
- **Mood rule — Reflections:** you can see the loot, the exit, and the entities, and none of them are where they look. Mirrors show reflections that are delayed by a second (a teammate's reflection can be wrong). Shattering glass (a crowbar, the shotgun) opens paths and is the loudest thing in the level.
- **Hazards:** Shattered glass (bleeds), dead ends that look open, falls through glass floors.
- **Entities: Mirror Things** (a player's reflection that steps out of a mirror when they've looked at it too long; it's a Skin-Stealer variant made of glass and it shatters on a hit), **Smilers** reflected (one Smiler, many reflections; only one is real).
- **Loot:** High and fragile: glass sculptures, crystal glassware, a mirror that shows somewhere else (anomalous), lenses.
- **Labs:** Lab Nu, behind frosted glass that has to be broken.
- **Exits:** A mirror that's a door (Level 14); the subway's glass station (Level 11); a shattered floor (Level 16).

### Level 14: Inhospitallity

- **Look:** An endless hospital: wards, corridors with gurneys, operating theaters, a reception, a morgue; flickering lights; the smell of antiseptic; announcements over the PA paging doctors who aren't there.
- **Generation:** Wings of wards around nurses' stations; floors connected by stairs and elevators; a morgue in the basement.

- **Mood rule — Triage:** the hospital heals: beds restore health, the pharmacy has every medical item in the game, and a player who lies on a gurney for 10 s is fully healed. It also admits: a player who's low on health is paged by name over the PA, and something comes to take them to surgery.
- **Hazards:** Locked wards; the morgue's drawers; the PA (it says where you are).
- **Entities: The Orderlies** (tall figures in scrubs who come for paged players and wheel them away on a gurney: a player taken is found on an operating table in the theater with half health and a missing item; or a kidney, and a note), **Dullers** in the waiting rooms.
- **Loot:** High: medical equipment, a pharmacy's stock, surgical instruments, the morgue's tagged personal effects (valuable, cursed).
- **Labs:** Lab Xi, in the hospital's records room.
- **Exits:** The ambulance bay (Level 11); a morgue drawer (Level 16); an elevator (Level 15).

## Level 15: Futuristic Halls

- **Look:** Clean white corridors with glowing panels, sliding doors, terminals, and holographic signs; someone's idea of the future, empty and humming.
- **Generation:** A grid of corridors and rooms with automated doors; terminals; a central control room.
- **Mood rule — The System:** the level is run by a computer. Terminals show maps, open doors, and lock them; they also log the crew's position, and the system's security responds. A crew that hacks a terminal (a 15 s mini-game: match the pattern) controls a section; a crew that fails is locked in.
- **Hazards:** Sliding doors that close on you; security drones that tase (electrocution); decontamination rooms (sealed, gassed briefly).
- **Entities: Sentries** (security robots that patrol on routes and shoot taser darts; disabled by EMP or hacking), **Facelings** in lab coats.
- **Loot:** Very high, light: data drives, prototype devices (anomalous), a robot's core, a holographic projector.
- **Labs:** Lab Omicron, which is already powered (it's part of the system) but locked; a hack opens it.
- **Exits:** An elevator (Level 14 or 17); a maintenance hatch (Level 13); the control room's hidden door (Level 18).

## Level 16: J. Barry Mental Asylum

- **Look:** A decaying 1950s asylum: tiled corridors, padded cells, a day room with a TV, an administration wing, restraint beds, peeling paint.
- **Generation:** Wings of cells around day rooms; an administration block; a basement with the boiler and the records.
- **Mood rule — Lockdown:** at intervals the asylum's bell rings and every door locks for a minute; anyone in a corridor is out in the open, anyone in a cell is safe and trapped. Sanity drains 2×; at low sanity, the PA speaks to you by name.
- **Hazards:** Lockdowns; cells that lock from outside; the boiler.
- **Entities: The Patients** (figures in gowns who follow at a distance and stop when seen, like the Neighbors; in groups they block corridors), **Wretches** in the basement, **The Warden** (a single entity in the administration wing who walks the halls during lockdowns with keys; if it finds a player in a corridor, it puts them in a cell).
- **Loot:** High: patient files (the Bureau pays for records), restraints, an old radio, the administrator's safe.
- **Labs:** Lab Pi, in the basement's records room.
- **Exits:** The boiler (Level 13); the front gate (Level 14); the chapel's altar (Level 19).

## Level 17: Abandoned Carrier

- **Look:** An enormous aircraft carrier adrift on a grey sea: a flight deck with derelict aircraft, a hangar deck, endless steel corridors below, bunk rooms, the bridge.
- **Generation:** A fixed carrier hull with generated interior decks and corridors; the flight deck and bridge are set pieces.
- **Mood rule — The Ship:** the carrier rolls with the sea, and the angle changes what's loose and where water goes; bulkhead doors seal compartments; the lower decks flood as the day goes on. The flight deck is open and windswept: the best loot (aircraft parts) and nowhere to hide.
- **Hazards:** Flooding compartments, falling cargo when the ship rolls, the flight deck's edge, the elevators.
- **Entities: The Crew** (Skin-Stealer sailors who wear uniforms and run drills), **Hounds** in the hangar, something under the hull (the sea is Level 7's sea).
- **Loot:** Very high and heavy: aircraft instruments, a jet's black box, the ship's bell, the armory's crates, the captain's log.
- **Labs:** Lab Rho, in the ship's sick bay.

- **Exits:** Over the side (Level 7); the bridge's ladder (Level 11, a rooftop); the hangar elevator, when it works (Level 15).

## Level 18: Nostalgic Memories

- **Look:** A place made of childhood: a school, a playground, a living room from the nineties, a birthday party, a summer camp. Bright, warm, slightly wrong; music from a toy.
- **Generation:** Rooms and outdoor scenes from a kit of "memories", stitched together without logic; a schoolhouse is the hub.
- **Mood rule — Comfort:** Level 18 restores sanity (+1 per 30 s just by being here) and that's the trap: it's hard to leave. A player who stays more than 10 minutes gets the **Stay** prompt every minute, and if they accept it once by accident they're gone for the day (they appear back on the Surface in the morning, with nothing, saying they had a lovely time).
- **Hazards:** The Stay prompt; rooms that loop; toys that are noisy loot.
- **Entities: The Friends** (child-sized figures who want to play; harmless; they take your loot to their "clubhouse" if you put it down), **Partygoers** (the birthday party is theirs).
- **Loot:** High, sentimental, and strange: a toy collection, a lunchbox, a yearbook (with your name in it), a game console, a birthday cake (it's fine).
- **Labs:** Lab Sigma, in the school's gym.
- **Exits:** The schoolhouse front door (Level 4); a slide in the playground (Level 9); a closet (Level 19).

## Level 19: Abyss Inn

- **Look:** An old inn on the edge of a chasm with no bottom: a lobby with a fire, a bar, rooms upstairs, a balcony over the abyss, and below it, nothing.
- **Generation:** An inn (rooms from Level 5's kit, rotted) built along a cliff edge, with rooms that hang over the abyss on stilts and corridors that end in air.
- **Mood rule — The Edge:** the abyss pulls: standing within 3 m of the edge for more than 5 s drains sanity fast and, at low sanity, walks you toward it. Falling in is death (you respawn on the Surface; your carry is gone). The inn is the deepest Lab and the end of the map: the most valuable loot in the game is in its rooms and on its ledges.
- **Hazards:** The edge; rotten floors over the abyss; the innkeeper's bell.

- **Entities: The Innkeeper** (an entity that's polite, offers you a room, and if you sleep in one you lose the night; it fights anyone who steals from the inn's bar), **Smilers** in the dark rooms, the abyss itself (a sound from below that gets closer when you're near the edge).
- **Loot:** The best in the game: the inn's ledger (a list of every guest, including the crew), an antique key that opens something in Level 5's penthouse, a lantern from the bottom of the abyss (no one knows how), the guest rooms' luggage.
- **Labs:** Lab Omega, in the inn's wine cellar: the deepest Lab, the hardest restart, and the campaign's long goal.
- **Exits:** The front door (Level 16); the attic stairs (Level 12); the balcony (into the abyss: a noclip, they say, to somewhere beyond the map; in the game, a rare chance to land in Level 0 and a far likelier death).

## Connections for 10–19

| From                  | Doors and stairs to                                                    | Noclip to                |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 10 Bumper Crop        | 11 (road), 8 (barn cellar)                                             | 9 (crop circle)          |
| 11 Concrete Jungle    | 13 or 15 (subway), 10 (storm drain), 17 (tower roof), 12 (white house) | —                        |
| 12 Aedificium         | 11 (garage), 19 (attic), 9 (front door, sometimes)                     | —                        |
| 13 Vitrum Madness     | 14 (mirror door), 11 (glass station)                                   | 16 (shattered floor)     |
| 14 Inhospitality      | 11 (ambulance bay), 16 (morgue drawer), 15 (elevator)                  | —                        |
| 15 Futuristic Halls   | 14 or 17 (elevator), 13 (hatch), 18 (hidden door)                      | —                        |
| 16 Asylum             | 13 (boiler), 14 (front gate), 19 (chapel altar)                        | —                        |
| 17 Carrier            | 7 (over the side), 11 (bridge ladder), 15 (hangar elevator)            | —                        |
| 18 Nostalgic Memories | 4 (school door), 9 (slide), 19 (closet)                                | —                        |
| 19 Abyss Inn          | 16 (front door), 12 (attic)                                            | The balcony (0 or death) |

The deep levels connect to the first ten through four two-way doors in the first ten: Level 8's farm-cellar ladder (to 10), Level 9's crop circle (to 10) and white house (to 12), Level 7's open sea (to 17), and Level 4's school door (to 18). Level 11 is the deep hub; Level 19 is the end.

## New entities in the deep levels

| Entity    | Levels | Hunts by        | Behavior                                                                   | Tell                     | Counter                                         |
|-----------|--------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Scarecrow | 10     | Being unwatched | On a different pole each time; one comes down at dusk and stalks the wheat | A pole with no scarecrow | Keep it in sight; climb high; burn it (a flare) |

| Entity        | Levels | Hunts by                  | Behavior                                                                               | Tell                    | Counter                                                                      |
|---------------|--------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Seer          | 12     | Sight                     | Eyes in every surface; three at once draw the house                                    | An eye opens            | Break line of sight; cover them (a coat, a sheet)                            |
| Mirror Thing  | 13     | Your gaze                 | Your reflection steps out after you've looked at it 5 s; mimics you; shatters on a hit | Your reflection is late | Don't stare at mirrors; hit it once                                          |
| Orderly       | 14     | The PA's page             | Comes for a low-health player and wheels them to surgery                               | Your name on the PA     | Heal above half; hide in a ward with the door shut                           |
| Sentry        | 15     | Motion on its route       | Patrols; tases                                                                         | A red scanning light    | Hack a terminal to stop it; EMP                                              |
| Patient       | 16     | Being unwatched           | Follows; stops when seen                                                               | Footsteps in a gown     | Watch it, move as a group                                                    |
| The Warden    | 16     | Corridors during lockdown | Puts players in cells                                                                  | Keys jingling           | Be in a cell when the bell rings; pick the lock (crowbar, loud)              |
| The Crew      | 17     | Sight and voice           | Skin-Stealer sailors who run drills                                                    | A bosun's whistle       | As Skin-Stealers                                                             |
| The Friends   | 18     | Dropped loot              | Take what you put down                                                                 | Giggles                 | Don't put loot down; play with them (a 10 s mini-game) and they give it back |
| The Innkeeper | 19     | Theft                     | Polite until you take from the bar                                                     | A bell rings            | Pay for drinks (yes, really)                                                 |

## Deep loot values and the quota

Deep loot runs 150–2,500 per item (the inn's ledger is the most valuable thing in the game), which is what makes week five's quota (2,300) and week eight's (6,400) reachable. Quotas past week four grow 35% a week instead of 40%. Lab restarts in the deep levels need two fuel canisters and a part found in the level (a fuse from 15, a ward key from 14, a ship's breaker from 17).

## Moving between levels

The ten levels are one connected place. Getting between them is half the game: every level has several exits to others, some reliable and some not, and a crew's knowledge of them is its real map.

### Kinds of exit

| Exit                    | How it works                                                                                                                                                                       | Reliability                                                                                                                                         | Cost                                                         |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Doors and stairs</b> | A physical door, stairwell, ladder, elevator, drain, or tunnel that leads to a specific level                                                                                      | Fixed for the day (same seed); it's always where the generator placed it                                                                            | Finding it                                                   |
| <b>Noclip spots</b>     | A wall, floor, or object that's slightly wrong (a manila-paper room, a flickering wall, a steam vent, a cubicle with no walls). Walking into it at a run drops you through reality | The destination is one of two levels, weighted; a group that noclips together arrives together only if they hold hands (grab each other within 1 s) | 10 sanity; a 2 s blackout on arrival in which you can't move |
| <b>The Lab network</b>  | Every online Lab is synced; a player at any online Lab's portal can jump to any other online Lab (see The Lab network)                                                             | Perfect                                                                                                                                             | A 10 s charge; one jump per player per in-game hour          |
| <b>Being taken</b>      | The Level 7 Leviathan, a Lost player's wander, a Skin-Stealer's drag                                                                                                               | It goes where it goes                                                                                                                               | Everything                                                   |

### The connection map

The default connections (a day's seed can add or remove a noclip spot, never a door):

| From                 | Doors and stairs to                                 | Noclip to                         |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 0 Lobby              | 2 (stairwell, sometimes)                            | 1 (manila room), 1 (carpet stain) |
| 1 Habitable Zone     | 2 (stairs down), 3 (loading door, rare)             | 0, 4                              |
| 2 Pipe Dreams        | 3 (manhole), 4 (crawl pipe), 1 (stairs up)          | 1                                 |
| 3 Electrical Station | 4 (elevator, powered), 2 (ladder), 1 (freight door) | 6                                 |
| 4 Abandoned Office   | 5 (stairs up), 3 (stairs down), 2/5/6 (elevator)    | 0                                 |
| 5 Terror Hotel       | 6 (furnace), 4/7 (elevator), 7 (window)             | —                                 |
| 6 Lights Out         | 7 (end door), 8 (pit)                               | 0 (walk long enough)              |
| 7 Thalassophobia     | 8 (drain, the deep), 6 (front door)                 | —                                 |
| 8 Cave System        | 9 (tunnel), 1 (climb)                               | 7 (river)                         |
| 9 Darkened Suburbs   | 8 (storm drain), 4 (store back door, rare)          | 0 (the lit house)                 |

The shape: Levels 0–4 are a tangle near the start; 5–8 are a descent; 9 is the deepest, reached only through the caves (or rarely from the office). The way home is always either a Lab or a path up.

## The map screen

Each player carries a **Bureau field map** (the M key): a hand-drawn chart that fills in as the crew explores. It shows the current level's rooms the crew has seen (shared, if they're within proximity range when they see them, or synced at a Lab), every exit found with its destination (once used or once its Archive fragment is read), Labs (dormant or online), and the crew's positions (only if a teammate has a radio). Sanity below 30 distorts the map by one room. A level's map resets each day (new seed), but exits learned stay learned as **kinds** ("the manila room is always the noclip to 1").

## Routes

A day's plan is a route: Lab → levels → Lab. A good route has a Lab at each end, passes through one high-loot level, avoids today's active-entity levels in the forecast, and comes home before 18:00. The Observation Room's cameras and the Archive's map fragments make better routes possible, which is the progression a crew feels.

## Entities

Entities are rare, readable, and different from each other: every one has a sense it hunts by, a tell, and a counter. They're the Backrooms' shared cast reinterpreted as game behavior, and the Bureau's dossier (a field guide in the Archive) fills in as the crew photographs each one.

| Entity          | Levels                      | Hunts by            | Behavior                                                                                                                          | Tell                                                                      | Counter                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Smiler</b>   | 0, 3, 6, 9<br>(dark places) | Light               | Only a face of glowing eyes and teeth in the dark; approaches anyone whose light is pointed at it or near it; charges and does 60 | A grin appears in the dark; your headlamp flickers when one's within 10 m | Point light away, back off slowly, and never run; a flare scares it off for 30 s; a lit room it can't enter    |
| <b>Hound</b>    | 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 8, 9         | Sound and blood     | A gaunt humanoid on all fours with a too-wide mouth; packs of 2-3; chases sprinting and bleeding players; 30 per bite             | Panting and scrabbling; a howl before the pack moves                      | Walk, don't run; stand still and hold eye contact (it hesitates); bandage bleeds; a slammed door holds it 10 s |
| <b>Faceling</b> | 0, 1, 4                     | — (mostly harmless) | A humanoid with no face; wanders; some are traders (swap loot for almond water); a few are aggressive if touched                  | Silent; they stop when you look at them                                   | Don't touch; trade if they offer                                                                               |
| <b>Duller</b>   | 1, 4                        | Proximity           | Grey, slow, droning humanoids during lights-out; swarm anyone who stops moving                                                    | A low drone like the hum                                                  | Keep moving; light makes them freeze                                                                           |

| Entity              | Levels     | Hunts by         | Behavior                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Tell                                                                                                               | Counter                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------|------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Wretch</b>       | 2          | Sanity           | Feral once-humans with grey skin; they come for the player with the lowest sanity                                                                                                                                                                                   | Muttering in the pipes                                                                                             | Keep sanity up (almond water); a group with high sanity is invisible to them                                                                                          |
| <b>Clump</b>        | 2          | Touch and heat   | A mass of limbs that crawls along pipes and drops on anything below                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Pipes clank overhead                                                                                               | Look up; stay away from pipe-heavy junctions; fire (a flare)                                                                                                          |
| <b>Skin-Stealer</b> | 3, 5, 6, 9 | Sight and voice  | A tall, pale entity that wears human skin. It <b>mimics a teammate's voice</b> (from their recent proximity audio) and lures; if it catches a lone player, it takes them: the player is dead and a Skin-Stealer with their name, voice, and outfit rejoins the crew | Its "teammate" says lines a beat late; its walk is too smooth; it never picks up loot; it won't drink almond water | Ask questions only the real teammate knows; offer almond water; stay together; the Bureau's scanner (shop) shows a heartbeat                                          |
| <b>Partygoer</b>    | 4, 5       | Invitation       | Smiling figures in party hats who want you to come to the party; harmless until you accept a balloon or an invitation (a prompt)                                                                                                                                    | Party music, a balloon drifting past                                                                               | Never accept; their balloons can be popped; a crew that "joins the party" is removed from the level and appears in the ballroom of Level 5 with their pockets emptied |
| <b>Deathmoth</b>    | 3, 7, 8    | Light and warmth | Giant moths; larvae nest in warm corners; adults swarm lights; their dust poisons (sanity and health)                                                                                                                                                               | Fluttering; dust in the beam                                                                                       | Turn off lights; fire; don't touch eggs (unless a contract wants them; they're valuable)                                                                              |

| Entity                       | Levels | Hunts by               | Behavior                                                                                                       | Tell                              | Counter                                                                      |
|------------------------------|--------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Neighbors</b>         | 9      | Being looked away from | Figures in windows that are closer each time you look away; reach you if you turn your back on one long enough | A silhouette in a lit window      | Keep a teammate watching while you work (one player is the Neighbor-watcher) |
| <b>Crawler / Cave Spider</b> | 8      | Vibration              | Large many-eyed arachnids in webs and chasms; webs hold a player for a bite                                    | Web strands tremble               | Burn webs; walk on rock not dust; spiders hate the crystal light             |
| <b>The Leviathan of 7</b>    | 7      | Time in the water      | An enormous shape in the dark water; takes anyone in the water too long                                        | The water goes still; a low groan | Keep swims under 60 s; have a rope from the house                            |

## Entity rules

- Each level has a population budget per hour that rises after 18:00 and triples in Overtime. The forecast says which levels are active today.
- Entities move between levels only through the same exits players use (a Hound pack can follow a crew down a stairwell).
- Entities that see each other mostly ignore each other; Smilers avoid Skin-Stealers; Hounds chase Facelings; that's enough to be exploitable.
- **Photographs:** a Bureau camera (shop) can photograph an entity for the dossier: a first photo of each entity pays a bounty and unlocks its counter tip in the Archive. The photo has to be in frame, lit, and within 15 m, which is the problem.

## Loot

Loot is objects that were lost into the Backrooms from the real world, plus a few things that only exist there. Every item has a **size**, a **weight**, a **value range** (rolled when found), and sometimes a **property**. Values rise with level number; the deepest loot is worth ten times the shallowest.

## By level (examples; each level has 15–20 items)

| Level | Small                                    | Medium                                           | Large or huge                                     | Value range |
|-------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 0     | Wallet, VHS tape, keys, a flashlight     | A backpack, an office chair, a lamp              | —                                                 | 5–40        |
| 1     | Batteries, a can of food, a Bureau badge | A supply crate, a toolbox, a jerrycan            | A pallet of almond water (huge)                   | 15–80       |
| 2     | A pressure gauge, a brass valve          | A lost crew's toolbox, a pipe wrench             | A copper pipe section (large)                     | 20–120      |
| 3     | A fuse, a radio tube                     | A working radio, copper coils                    | A transformer core (huge)                         | 30–250      |
| 4     | A stapler, a USB drive (documents)       | A computer tower, a coffee machine, a desk plant | A filing cabinet (large)                          | 15–150      |
| 5     | Jewelry, a key card, a cufflink          | A gramophone, champagne, a silver tray           | A grandfather clock (huge)                        | 50–400      |
| 6     | A camera with film, a battery box        | A glowing lantern                                | — (nothing large survives here)                   | 100–500     |
| 7     | A pocket watch                           | A diving helmet, the family silver               | A ship's bell (large), a waterlogged chest (huge) | 80–450      |
| 8     | A crystal, gold ore                      | Mining equipment, a researcher's journal         | A crystal cluster (large)                         | 100–700     |
| 9     | A family photo, a toy, a remote          | A TV, a register drawer, a car battery           | A grand piano (huge, impossible, worth it)        | 120–900     |

## Properties

| Property         | Effect                                                                                     |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fragile</b>   | Breaks if dropped from height or hit; worth nothing broken (champagne, the gramophone)     |
| <b>Noisy</b>     | Makes a sound when carried (a music box, a ticking clock, a toy that talks); Hounds follow |
| <b>Glowing</b>   | A light source (the lantern, crystals); Smilers and Deathmoths follow                      |
| <b>Heavy</b>     | Two-handed or two-player                                                                   |
| <b>Cursed</b>    | Drains the carrier's sanity (a doll, a mirror shard, a Partygoer's balloon); worth a lot   |
| <b>Living</b>    | Moves (a Deathmoth egg, a jar with something in it); can escape                            |
| <b>Anomalous</b> | Does something (below)                                                                     |

## Anomalous objects

Rare items (one in fifty) with a function that's also loot:

- **Almond Water (Pure):** heals all meters fully; worth more sold than drunk.
- **The Lucky Die:** roll it; a random effect for the day (good or bad).
- **A Bureau Compass That Works:** points to the nearest Lab on any level.
- **The Smiler's Tooth:** Smilers ignore the carrier; it's worth a lot and it whispers.
- **The Exit Sign:** placed on any door, it makes that door an exit to the level of the crew's choice, once.
- **A Faceling's Mask:** the wearer is ignored by Facelings and Dullers; Skin-Stealers want it.
- **The Empty Room Key:** opens a room that wasn't there (a pocket room: safe storage for the day).
- **The Hotel Penthouse Key:** opens the penthouse on Level 5 (a vault of jewelry and the Terror Hotel's worst guest).

## Value

Sold value depends on the buyer (the Bureau pays quota credit at a fixed rate; the Fence pays cash at market rates that change daily) and on condition (damaged items are worth half). Every item is logged on the Surface with its level and a one-line description: collectors' notes from the Bureau, dry and funny.

## Equipment

Bought on the Surface between days (delivered with the crew at insertion) or at a Lab's Commissary (more expensive, but available mid-day). Equipment is cheap enough that a crew always has some and expensive enough that every purchase is a trade against quota.

| Item             | Price | What it does                                                                          |
|------------------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Headlamp battery | 10    | 10 minutes of light (5× faster drain on Level 6)                                      |
| Flashlight       | 25    | A focused beam; the Smiler's problem                                                  |
| Glow sticks (5)  | 15    | 2 minutes of light each (30 s on Level 6); drop to mark a route                       |
| Flare            | 30    | 30 s of red light; scares Smilers and Clumps; draws everything else                   |
| Almond water     | 20    | +25 sanity, +10 health, and a full stamina refill                                     |
| Medkit           | 60    | Heals 50; revives in 6 s                                                              |
| Bandages (3)     | 25    | Stops bleeding; fixes sprains                                                         |
| Splint           | 30    | Fixes a break                                                                         |
| Radio            | 50    | Talk to the crew at any range on the same level (crackly); shows teammates on the map |
| Rope (20 m)      | 40    | Climb, descend, haul loot up a shaft, tie to a swimmer                                |
| Crowbar          | 35    | Pries doors, crates, vents; a weapon (20, stuns a Hound)                              |
| Cart             | 80    | Carries 6 medium or 2 large items; loud on hard floors                                |

| Item                   | Price | What it does                                                                                               |
|------------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bureau camera          | 70    | Photographs entities (dossier bounties) and documents; the flash scares a Smiler                           |
| Scanner                | 120   | A heartbeat monitor: shows living things within 20 m; reveals Skin-Stealers (no heartbeat)                 |
| Breathing tank         | 100   | 3 minutes underwater (Level 7)                                                                             |
| Fuel canister          | 40    | Runs a Lab generator for a day                                                                             |
| Noise maker            | 30    | A wind-up toy that walks and makes noise for 20 s; Hounds follow it                                        |
| Shotgun (Bureau-issue) | 300   | Two shells; stuns any entity for 5 s; loud enough to draw everything on the level; a crew owns at most one |
| Exit chalk             | 15    | Mark walls; marks persist for the day; the classic way not to get lost                                     |
| Music box              | 45    | Wound and set down, restores 2 sanity per 10 s to anyone within 5 m for a minute; Partygoers love it       |
| Grappling hook         | 90    | Fire to a ledge 15 m; Level 8's best friend                                                                |
| Thermal flask          | 25    | Halves the stamina drain from heat (Levels 2 and 3) and cold (Level 7) for 10 minutes                      |

## Suits (permanent upgrades, bought once)

A hazmat suit (heat's stamina and sanity drains halved; no Deathmoth poison), a wetsuit (cold water halved), a backpack with an extra slot, boots (silent on hard floors), a hard hat with a stronger lamp, and the **Bureau Field Kit** (a better map that shows exits once they're within 20 m).

## The Surface

The real world is the Bureau's warehouse on an industrial estate at night: a loading bay, a portal ring identical to the Labs', a sales counter, the Fence's van in the car park, a vending machine, and a whiteboard. It's the crew's safe room and its spreadsheet.

## Selling

- Extracted loot comes through the portal in the Bureau's crate onto the loading bay.
- **The Bureau** buys for **quota credit** at a fixed rate (the item's base value). Only Bureau sales count toward the quota. The Bureau pays 20% of credit as cash too.
- **The Fence** (a man in a van called Dez) buys for **cash** at a rate that changes daily ("crystals are hot, office chairs aren't"); he pays more than the Bureau for anomalous and cursed items and asks no questions. Fence sales don't count toward the quota.
- The split is the decision: quota keeps the campaign alive; cash buys the gear that makes the next quota possible.

## The quota

Week 1: 600 credit. Each week +40% (week 2: 840; week 3: 1,180; week 4: 1,650; week 5: 2,300). A crew that hits the quota by day 2 can spend day 3 on cash or on contracts. The whiteboard shows the quota, credit so far, days left, and a running list of everything sold.

## Contracts

Each morning the Bureau offers one contract from a list; it pays a bonus in credit and cash if completed that day.

| Contract      | Task                                                                                                                                 | Pays                    |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Retrieval     | Bring back a named item from a named level (the Penthouse key, a transformer core, a crystal cluster)                                | 200–600 credit          |
| Rescue        | A lost Bureau crew's last signal is on a level; find the survivor (an NPC who follows you, slowly, with low sanity) and extract them | 400 credit, 200 cash    |
| Survey        | Map 80% of a level (the field map counts)                                                                                            | 250 credit              |
| Documentation | Photograph three different entities                                                                                                  | 300 credit              |
| Restart       | Bring a dormant Lab online                                                                                                           | 350 credit, and the Lab |
| Night Shift   | Survive Overtime in a Lab with at least 300 of loot                                                                                  | 500 credit              |

| Contract  | Task                                                                                         | Pays                              |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| The Party | Let one crew member accept a Partygoer's invitation, retrieve them from the Level 5 ballroom | 600 credit (it's a terrible idea) |
| Specimen  | Bring back a living thing (a Deathmoth egg, a jar from Level 2, a spider in a box)           | 450 cash                          |

## Between days

The crew can shop, install Lab upgrades, read the dossier, review the map, sell to the Fence, and pick tomorrow's insertion Lab. A day ends with a short Bureau memo (a joke about the day's events, written from the log: "Employee 3 noclipped twice; please stop").

## Multiplayer

1-6 players on the shared arcade layer. The crew shares a campaign, a quota, money, and a map; each player has their own body, meters, and hallucinations.

## Proximity voice

- Voice is positional within 25 m, muffled by walls, louder in tunnels and quieter in carpeted rooms. The radio (shop) carries it across a level.
- **Entities hear voices.** Talking is noise (a third of a footstep's alarm per second of speech); shouting is more. Hounds come to voices.
- **Skin-Stealers record voices.** The game keeps a rolling buffer of each player's recent proximity speech (on the host, for this purpose only, cleared at the end of the session) and plays clips from it as the mimic. Voice mimicry is on by default; a lobby toggle replaces it with synthesized speech for groups who prefer.
- Ghost players (Wanderers) whisper at 3 m.

## Roles

No classes; roles emerge from gear and habit. The crew usually settles into: a **Guide** at a Lab's Observation Room (cameras, intercom, map), a **Lead** with the flashlight and chalk, **Haulers** with the cart, and a **Watcher** for Level 9's Neighbors and the portal charge. A solo player can do it all slowly.

## Losing teammates

A crew that splits up loses sanity (the alone drain) and gains speed. A crew that stays together is safe and slow. The game's best moments come from someone wandering off.

## Sharing

Loot in a player's hands is theirs; loot in the crate is the crew's; money is the crew's; a player who sells their own carry to the Fence on the Surface does it for the crew. Cosmetics and tokens are personal.

## Modes, progression, and cosmetics

### Modes

| Mode                                   | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Bureau</b> (campaign)           | As designed: weeks of quotas until one is missed                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Lost</b>                            | No Surface: the crew starts in Level 0 with nothing and must find a Lab and restart it to escape. One life each. About 45 minutes                                                                                     |
| <b>Noclip Roulette</b>                 | Every exit is a noclip to a random level; the quota is low; chaos                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Lights Out</b>                      | Every level plays by Level 6's rule                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Expedition</b>                      | A single long day (60 minutes) with a contract at every level; no shop mid-run; scored                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Lonely</b>                          | One player, and the Backrooms adjust (fewer entities, more hallucinations)                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Skin-Stealer</b> (social deduction) | One player is secretly a Skin-Stealer from the start: they can't die, they can take one player per level, and they win if the crew misses the quota. The crew wins by extracting with them identified and left behind |

## Progression

Between campaigns a profile keeps: the dossier (entities photographed), Labs ever restarted, the best week reached, exits learned (as kinds), and the Bureau rank (Intern → Salvager → Senior Salvager → Field Lead → Liminal Specialist), which unlocks starting gear (a flashlight at Salvager; a radio at Senior; a scanner at Field Lead) and cosmetic titles.

## Cosmetics

Arcade tokens (10 per day survived, 50 per week's quota met, 25 per new entity photographed) buy suit colors, hard-hat stickers, vest patches, and headlamp colors. The crate (one token) holds 40 items in the arcade's usual four tiers: commons (sticker sets, colored vests), rares (a Faceling mask that's just a mask, a party hat, a wet-carpet texture suit), super rares (a Smiler grin on the hard hat that glows, a hi-vis Hound costume), and specials (the Yellow Wallpaper suit, the Bureau Director's coat, the Exit Sign hat, the Almond Water Bottle costume, a working lava lamp on the hard hat). Cosmetics never change the numbers, though a glowing hard hat is a light source and the Smilers know it.

## Presentation, generation, sound, and build order

### Look

NOCLIP has its own style, specific to this game (other Slop games choose their own): **found-footage liminal**. Low-poly first-person 3D with flat, overlit textures (the Backrooms' wallpaper, carpet, and concrete as procedurally generated tiling patterns), a VHS post-process (scanlines, chroma bleed, a timestamp in the corner that's the in-game clock), and fluorescent light that flickers. It deliberately doesn't use Depth's ink: these games are from somewhere else. The Labs are the one place that looks designed (brass and steel, the Depth palette), and the Surface is ordinary sodium-lit night.

### Generation

Each level has a generator (a module per level) seeded per day: Level 0 is a grid maze with wall removal; Level 1 is halls and racks; Level 2 is a corridor graph with junctions; Level 3 is a machine-hall grid with catwalks and a breaker graph; Level 4 is office blocks; Level 5 is floors of corridors with room kits; Level 6 is a long winding corridor; Level 7 is a house kit over a water volume; Level 8 is a 3D cave from noise with a guaranteed path graph; Level 9

is a street grid with house kits. Each generator places its Labs and exits at fixed rules (a Lab is always within 300 m of an exit to a shallower level) and runs a reachability check from every Lab to every exit, as the parkour side's `--verify` does.

Sound

The hum (Level 0's fluorescent buzz) is the game's identity and changes per level: the hum, warehouse drips, pipe hiss and clank, the station's transformer roar, office HVAC and a distant phone, hotel jazz and a vacuum somewhere, Lights Out's total silence and your own breathing, the house's creak and the ocean, the caves' drips and echoes, the suburbs' crickets and a far-off dog and the ice cream truck. Entities each have a tell (the Hounds' panting, the Smiler's faint giggle, the Partygoers' music, the Duller drone, the Clump's clank, Deathmoth wings, spiders' clicks, the Leviathan's groan). Proximity voice is reverb-processed by the room. Hallucinated sounds use the same assets, which is the trick.

Data

`noclip_levels.json` (each level's generator parameters, mood rule, hazards, entity budgets, loot tables, Labs, exits), `noclip_entities.json`, `noclip_loot.json`, `noclip_items.json`, `noclip_contracts.json`, `noclip_quota.json`, `noclip_cosmetics.json`.

Build order

| Stage | Work                                                                                                                                | Gate                                  |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1     | First-person body, meters, carrying, the headlamp; Level 0's generator; Lab Alpha; extraction                                       | One player loots Level 0 and extracts |
| 2     | Proximity voice and multiplayer (4 players) on the shared layer; death and Wanderers; the Surface, the Bureau, the Fence, the quota | A crew completes a week on Level 0    |
| 3     | Levels 1-4 with their generators, mood rules, Labs, and exits; Smilers, Hounds, Facelings, Dullers, Wretches, Clumps                | A crew routes 0 → 1 → 2 and back      |

| Stage | Work                                                                                                                            | Gate                                           |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 4     | Sanity and hallucinations; the map; contracts; equipment                                                                        | A Lost player wanders into a noclip            |
| 5     | Levels 5–9 and their entities (Skin-Stealers with voice mimicry, Partygoers, Deathmoths, the Neighbors, spiders, the Leviathan) | A crew reaches Level 9 by week four in testing |
| 6     | Lab upgrades, Overtime, modes (Lost, Skin-Stealer), progression, cosmetics, six players, internet play                          | All targets met or logged                      |

## Tests and targets

- `--noclip-gen <level> <seed>` prints a level's layout and asserts reachability from every Lab to every exit.
- `--noclip-sim <crew> <days>` runs a bot crew and reports: credit per day, deaths by cause, levels reached, quota met.
- A new crew meets week one's quota about 80% of the time and week three's about 40%; a veteran crew reaches week five.
- Deaths: entities 50%, hazards 25%, getting lost or Overtime 15%, teammates 10% (it happens).

## Open questions for the designer

- ☐ Decided: the voice-recording mimic is on by default.
- ☐ Decided: Levels 10–19 are part of the normal progression, open from the start and pushed into by the quota.
- ☐ Decided: the VHS style is NOCLIP's own, not a shelf-wide look.
- ☐ Decided: Skin-Stealer social deduction is a launch mode.